3.4 Applications of Curved Mirrors

Concave mirror

1. Concave mirrors are used while applying make-up or shaving, as they provide a magnified image.
2. They are used in torches, search lights and head lights as they direct the light to a long distance.
3. They can collect the light from a larger area and focus it into a small spot. Hence, they are used in solar cookers.
4. They are used as head mirrors by doctors to examine the eye, ear, nose and throat as they provide a shadow-free illumination of the organ.
5. They are also used in reflecting telescopes.



Figure 3.4 Uses of concave mirror

Convex mirror

1. Convex mirrors are used in vehicles as rear view mirrors because they give an upright image and provide a wider field of view as they are curved outwards.
2. They are found in the hallways of various buildings including hospitals, hotels, schools and stores. They are usually mounted on a wall or ceiling where hallways make sharp turns.
3. They are also used on roads where there are sharp curves and turns.



Figure 3.5 Uses of Convex mirror

Activity 2

List out various convex and concave mirrors used in daily life.

3.5 Laws of Reflection

Activity 3

Take a plane mirror and focus the light coming from the Sun on a wall. Can you see a bright spot on the wall? How does it occur? It is because the light rays falling on the mirror are bounced onto the wall. Can you produce the same bright spot with the help of any other object having a rough surface?

Not all the objects can produce the same effect as produced by the plane mirror. A ray of light, falling on a body having a shiny, polished and smooth surface alone is bounced back. This bouncing back of the light rays as they fall on the smooth, shiny and polished surface is called reflection.

Reflection involves two rays: incident ray and reflected ray. The incident ray is the light ray in a medium falling on the shiny surface of a reflecting body. After falling on the surface, this ray returns into the same medium. This ray is called the reflected ray. An imaginary line perpendicular to the reflecting surface, at the point of incidence of the light ray, is called the normal.

The relation between the incident ray, the reflected ray and the normal is given as the laws of reflection. The laws of reflection are as follows:

- The incident ray, the reflected ray and the normal at the point of incidence, all lie in the same plane.

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